

Sloppy Joes

Glazed beef · sweet-tangy · no-water method · the veg is the moisture

YIELD	ACTIVE	MEAT : SAUCE	BROWNING
907 g · 6	~25 min	2 : 1 by wt	375–400°F

TEMPERATURE TARGETS

a hard sear builds the fond — flavor base

Browning (pan)	375–400°F	Paste bloom	325–350°F
Aromatics sweat	medium-high	Final simmer	200–210°F

INGREDIENTS

907 g (2 lb) ground beef · 80/20 or 85/15

AROMATICS — 315 G

Yellow onion minced	200 g
Green bell pepper minced	100 g
Garlic minced	15 g

BINDING SAUCE

Ketchup	300 g
Tomato paste	20 g
Worcestershire	25 g
Brown sugar	20 g
Yellow mustard	16 g

SEASON & ACID

Kosher salt on beef	8 g
Coarse pepper on beef	2 g
Fine pepper finish	1 g
ACV 10 build + 5 finish	15 g
Guajillo powder	2 g
Smoked paprika	2 g

No-water method: the 315 g of onion + pepper *is* the liquid — they sweat their moisture into the glaze, so it never tastes dilute. **Retain 30–45 g of the rendered fat** after browning (drain the rest): too much reads greasy, too little and the bloom/sweat goes dry. **Split the acid — 10 g in the build, 5 g off-heat** — vinegar concentrates as it reduces, so the final splash is what keeps it bright instead of sharp.

Sear, Bloom & Glaze

METHOD

~25 min — sear hard, bloom the paste, reduce to a glaze

- 1 **Season:** toss 907 g beef with **8 g salt + 2 g coarse pepper**. Mix gently — don't compact it.
- 2 **Sear:** hot skillet, add beef, break into chunks, **brown well to build fond** (375–400°F). Retain **30–45 g fat**, drain the excess.
- 3 **Sweat:** add onion + pepper, cook **5–6 min** until softened and the moisture releases. Add garlic the **last 1–2 min only** (prevents bitter oxidation).
- 4 **Bloom:** clear the center, add tomato paste + guajillo + smoked paprika, stir in the center **60 sec** until the paste darkens (325–350°F).
- 5 **Build:** add ketchup, Worcestershire, mustard, brown sugar, and **10 g ACV** (reserve 5 g). Stir to combine.
- 6 **Reduce:** simmer uncovered **10–15 min**. Test: drag a spoon through — the channel should **hold 3–5 sec** before closing.
- 7 **Finish:** off heat, add the reserved **5 g ACV + 1 g fine pepper**. Taste, adjust salt, cover and **rest 5 min**.

TROUBLESHOOTING

salt window: ~8 g on beef, sauce adds ~4–5 g — taste-add only at the end

PROBLEM	CAUSE	FIX
Greasy / separates	Too much fat retained	Drain to 30–45 g; for 73/27 drain harder
Too sharp / tangy	Acid concentrated in the reduction	Stage it: 10 g build, 5 g off-heat finish
Flat / bland	No fond; paste not bloomed; beef unseasoned	Season beef first; hard sear; toast paste dark
Bitter undertone	Garlic oxidized; paste burnt	Add garlic only the last 1–2 min of sweat
Over-salted	Reduction concentrates the salt	Start at 7–8 g; add 2 g increments at the end
Doesn't glaze	Under-reduced	Spoon-drag test: channel holds 3–5 sec